

Decree of Ashen Silence Concerning House Morvain and Maelis Harrowick the Pale

Let this decree be read beneath the banners of judgment, and entered into every lawful record that still remains unburned.

Concerning House Morvain

House Morvain is acknowledged as an ancient noble house claiming descent from the last Sunder-Kings. Its authority rests upon that dynastic claim and the weight of its antiquity. Let no clerk diminish the claim, and let no herald enlarge it beyond the words set here.

The house shall present itself according to its own station: aristocratic and kingly, shaped by its claimed descent from the Sunder-Kings. Its seal, garments, halls, and manner of address may bear the marks of ancestral pride. Yet such pride shall not be mistaken for unexamined right. House Morvain carries itself with a guarded sense of entitlement; therefore, all petitions proceeding from it shall be heard with due regard and recorded without fear or favor.

No assertion of descent shall, by itself, erase a charge. No antiquity shall, by itself, cleanse a stain. The house may invoke its lineage, but the record shall retain every word spoken beneath oath.

Concerning Maelis Harrowick the Pale

Maelis Harrowick the Pale, born in **340 AS**, is a major **Court Chronicler**. Their station commands a careful hand, a faithful ink, and a memory that does not bend merely because the powerful prefer another shape for the past.

It is entered here that Maelis Harrowick the Pale plotted the death of their own liege.

Let no copyist soften the verb. Let no reader confuse concealment with restraint, nor watchfulness with innocence. The Pale may continue to bear the formal station of Court Chronicler only insofar as the lawfully kept record permits; the epithet shall remain attached to the name, for the record recognizes what is written and does not grant comfort where certainty is unwelcome.

Maelis's appearance is not established beyond the epithet **the Pale** and the formal station of Court Chronicler. Therefore, no portraitist, witness, or scribe shall supply invented features beneath this decree's authority. Let the absence remain an absence.

The account of Maelis shall be preserved in a restrained and watchful manner, as befits a chronicler concealing treason against their liege. House Morvain's ancestral pride shall not command the ink, and Maelis Harrowick the Pale's treason shall not be hidden by it.

So entered. So guarded. So read.